INTRODUCTION

Securing national interest is the prime motive of states in international relations and to that end they strive to amass national power vis-à-vis the other states, in order to gain control over them. But international relations is not left to the whims of the states as actors, and there are certain limitations to the actions of the states. These limitations act as constraints on the exercise of national power. International law, international morality and world public opinion act as definite constraints on national power. Even the sole surviving superpower, the United States, is not above international law, international morality, and world public opinion. It may manipulate, manoeuvre all the three to justify its actions, but it cannot ignore the three principal restraining factors in international relations.